Conversation track 15, 17, 18

Wesley has two job offers. His friend Rita wants to know which one he'll take.

Rita: So, two job offers! Have you decided yet?

Wesley: Not yet. The bank pays a lot more, **although** I'd be working twelve-hour days.

Rita: Ouch. What about the other one?

Wesley: It's a small startup. **Despite** the lower salary, I'd learn so much more there.

Rita: Startups can be risky, **though**. What if it shuts down next year?

Wesley: I know. **Even though** it's risky, I'm tempted. I really clicked with the team.

Rita: Sounds like you've already made up your mind.

Wesley: Maybe. My dad prefers the bank. **However**, he won't be the one working there!

Study Notes

I really clicked with the team.
Mình thấy rất hợp với cả nhóm.
"click with someone" = hợp nhau ngay từ đầu, "hợp cạ".
Cách nói tương đương: I really hit it off with the team.

Sounds like you've already made up your mind.
Nghe như bạn quyết rồi đấy.
"make up your mind" = quyết định sau khi cân nhắc. "Sounds like…" là dạng rút gọn của "It sounds like…".
Cách nói tương đương: You've already decided, haven't you?

Speak Like a Native track 16

1. The bank pays a lot more, although I'd be working twelve-hour days.
change: "lot more" (mất âm t)
weak: "I'd be"
strong: "twelve-hour days"
Âm /t/ của "lot" bị nuốt trước /m/: "ơ-la-mor". "I'd be" = I would be, đọc lướt "ai-bi". Nhấn "twelve-hour days" để than giờ làm quá dài.

2. Startups can be risky, though.
change: "can be" (n → m)
strong: "risky"
"can" đọc nhẹ /kən/, âm /n/ biến thành /m/ trước /b/: "cơm-bi". "though" ở cuối câu đọc nhẹ, thấp giọng, nghĩa là "nhưng mà".

3. Even though it's risky, I'm tempted.
change: "tempted" (mất âm p)
strong: "risky", "tempted"
"Even though" nhấn vào "though": "i-vơn-ĐÂU". Âm /p/ của "tempted" kẹp giữa /m/ và /t/ nên gần như mất: "tem-tịd". Vế đầu lên giọng nhẹ ở dấu phẩy.

• "I'd" + động từ nguyên mẫu = I would (I'd be, I'd learn); "I'd" + V3 = I had.
• although, even though nhấn vào "though" /ðoʊ/; despite và however nhấn âm thứ hai: de-SPITE, how-EV-er.
• Âm /n/ trước /b/, /p/, /m/ dễ biến thành /m/: can be → "cơm-bi".
• Câu nhượng bộ: vế đầu lên giọng nhẹ ở dấu phẩy, vế sau xuống giọng: Even though it's RISKY, I'm TEMPTED.

Grammar Focus

although / even though + mệnh đề

although / even though + chủ ngữ + động từ = mặc dù; even though nhấn mạnh hơn. Về sau không thêm "but" như "mặc dù… nhưng…" trong tiếng Việt.

Although it was late, we kept talking.
He kept running **even though** his knee hurt.

despite + danh từ / V-ing; however

despite + danh từ hoặc V-ing (không đi với mệnh đề). however mở đầu câu mới, sau nó là dấu phẩy; văn nói thân mật hay dùng though ở cuối câu.

Despite the rain, the game went ahead.
Despite feeling sick, he went to work.
The hotel was nice. **However**, the food was awful.

Role Play track 20

A: So, two job offers! Have you decided yet?

B: Not yet. The bank pays a lot more, although _____.

A: Ouch. What about the other one?

B: It's a small startup. Despite _____, I'd learn so much more there.

A: Startups can be risky, though. What if it shuts down next year?

B: I know. Even though _____, I'm tempted. I really clicked with the team.

A: Sounds like you've already made up your mind.

B: Maybe. My dad prefers the bank. However, he won't be the one working there!

Substitution Drill track 21

1. The bank pays a lot more, although **I'd be working twelve-hour days**.
   a. the commute is awful
   b. the boss seems scary
   c. I'd hardly see my family

2. Despite **the lower salary**, I'd learn so much more there.
   a. the long hours
   b. the tiny office
   c. earning less money

3. Even though **it's risky**, I'm tempted.
   a. the pay is lower
   b. my dad disagrees
   c. it might not last